ADVISORY

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Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre
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AI-Assisted Financially Motivated Cyber Attacks on NBFCs and FinTech Platforms

The **National Cybercrime Threat Analysis Unit (NCTAU)** of **Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) and CERT-In, Ministry of Electronics and IT** has noticed a trend in cyber-attacks based cyber frauds on Banks, Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) and FinTech Companies. These attacks are financially motivated and are being carried out with the help of Artificial Intelligence (AI) agents leading to machine speed compromise. Multi-crore unauthorized transaction through fund disbursement systems and APIs are being found in individual cases.

How Do the Attackers Operate?

- Perpetrators exploit unpatched software or mis-configured internet exposed Servers / IT systems to compromise the infrastructure. This also includes customer end complaint interface.
- Hackers then target automated fund disbursement systems or special interfaces (APIs) used for payments and fund transfers. Use of Agentic AI Framework makes the attack possible at machine speed.
- The money is sent to “mule” accounts (accounts used by criminals) across different banks and then quickly moved or withdrawn through IMPS/NEFT.
- Then perpetrator delete records and hide their tracks so that investigation becomes difficult.

What Should Financial Institutions Do?

All banks, NBFCs, FinTechs, payment aggregators/gateways and other financial entities are advised to implement, on priority, the measures in CERT-In Advisory **CIAD-2026-0046** “Threat Actors Exploiting Payment and Disbursement APIs for Unauthorized Fund Transfers in BFSI Entities” (9 October 2026, Severity: Critical) and CERT-In Advisory **CIAD-2026-0049** “AI Agents as Attack Vectors” (15 October 2026, Severity: Critical), and to align their controls with frameworks such as the CERT-In “Blueprint for Reducing Exposure and Defending against AI-Assisted Vulnerabilities Exploitation in Digital Infrastructure” (May 2026) and the cyber security frameworks prescribed by their respective sectoral regulators.

- Report any cyber incident to CERT-In within 6 hours of noticing it.
- Banks and NBFCs must report to RBI on the DAKSH portal within six hours of detection.
- NBFCs and Fintechs may contact I4C for bulk reporting of fraudulent transactions on the NCRP-CFCFRMS portal so that defrauded money can be frozen

Additional Measures to of Safeguarding:

- Keep a complete list of all digital interfaces (APIs) used for payments and remove or switch off old, unused or test interfaces.
- Bank's Chief Information Security Officer's Team and Transaction Monitoring Team and IT Team may work in close coordination for proactively mitigating the API attack risks.
- Set daily and per-transaction limits, verify beneficiary names and accounts, and watch for unusual speed of transactions.
- Banks Check for NBFC's Access token failures from non-whitelisted IPs.
- Strengthen the customer facing & complaint receiving infrastructure for any potential attempts of intrusion. Thorough secure architecture review may be conducted to prevent lateral movement.
- Sudden change in transaction narration patterns and beneficiary profiles or volume may be monitored by transaction monitoring team.
- Make sure money cannot be sent out unless all earlier checks (KYC, approval, etc.) have been completed properly.
- Run authorised red-team exercises that simulate machine-speed attacks, and measure how quickly SOC and payment controls respond.